About Validation Reliance & Revalidation Standard

Governing When Validation May Be Relied Upon — and When It

Must Be Validated Again

Validation does not end when an object becomes:

Validated.

That state creates a new governance question:

Who or what may now rely upon it, for what purpose, under which conditions, and for how long?

A second question follows when reality changes:

When is the existing validation basis no longer sufficient, and what must be validated again?

Validation Reliance & Revalidation Standard (VRRS) is the tenth and final Parent Standard of **VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture.**

It governs the final operational relationship between:
Validation State

and:

Reliance

while establishing the mechanism through which changed validation reality returns the Validation Object into a governed validation cycle.

VRRS therefore closes one lifecycle while simultaneously allowing another to begin.

Why Validation Reliance & Revalidation Standard Exists

Validation is frequently interpreted too broadly.

An object receives a validation result and the result gradually becomes treated as if it meant:

Approved

Safe

Reliable Everywhere

Suitable for Every Use

Valid Forever

or:

May Be Relied Upon Without Further Question

VALIDOS® rejects that interpretation.

A Validation State is evidence about the validation condition of an object.

It is not universal permission to rely upon that object.

VRRS exists to govern the boundary between:

What has been validated

and:

what someone intends to do because of that validation.

Validation State Is Not Reliance

The ninth Parent Standard establishes:

What Validation State does the object legitimately hold now?

VRRS asks:

Is that state sufficient for this specific reliance?

Therefore:

Validation State ≠ Validation Reliance

An AI model may legitimately hold:

Validated for advisory use.

That does not automatically support:

Autonomous Final Decision

The Validation State may be legitimate.

The proposed reliance may still be illegitimate.

Reliance Creates a New Governance Relationship

Validation originally concerns:

Validation Object ↔ Validation Basis

Reliance introduces another actor and another purpose.

The relationship becomes:

Validation Object

↓

Validation State

↓

Relying Actor

↓

Reliance Purpose

↓

Reliance Scope

↓

Reliance Conditions

↓

Reliance Decision

This matters because the same Validation Object may simultaneously support several different reliance outcomes.

One Validation State Can Produce Different Reliance Decisions

Consider one AI system holding a current:

Validated

state.

It may be:

Reliance Eligible for internal analytical assistance.

Conditionally Reliance Eligible for professional decision support.

Reliance Not Eligible for autonomous high-consequence decisions.

The underlying Validation State has not changed.

The reliance context has.

This distinction prevents validation from becoming a universal authorization mechanism.

Reliance Must Have a Purpose

VRRS requires the intended reliance purpose to be identifiable.

Possible purposes may include:

- information,
- recommendation,
- decision support,
- automated decision,
- operational control,
- deployment dependency,
- safety assurance,
- financial decision,
- medical decision,
- regulatory assessment,
- or another governed use.

Validation established for one purpose should not silently support another.

Reliance Must Have a Scope

Reliance cannot legitimately exceed the applicable Validation State.

VALIDOS® therefore establishes:

Reliance Scope ≤ Validation State Applicability

If validation covers:

Adult Population

reliance cannot silently expand to:

All Populations

If validation covers:

Environment A

reliance cannot automatically extend to:

Environment B

If validation covers:

Decision Support

reliance cannot automatically become:

Reliance Has Consequence

Two actors may use the same validated object for radically different purposes.

One may use a prediction to select which report to read.

Another may use the same prediction to move millions of dollars.

The validation requirement should not necessarily be identical.

VRRS therefore introduces:

Reliance Consequence

The higher the consequence of reliance, the stronger the validation basis that may be required.

Validated Does Not Mean Sufficient

This creates an important VALIDOS® distinction:

Validated ≠ Reliance Sufficient

An object may legitimately be Validated while the Validation Depth supporting that state remains insufficient for a proposed high-consequence reliance.

This allows validation to remain truthful without overstating what the validation can support.

Reliance Eligibility

VRRS may classify reliance as:

Reliance Eligible

Reliance Conditionally Eligible

Reliance Partially Eligible

Reliance Eligibility Undetermined

Reliance Not Eligible

This provides a governed answer to:

Can this Validation State support this reliance context?

Reliance Eligibility Is Not Authorization

Even sufficient validation does not create authority.

VRRS therefore separates:

Reliance Eligibility

from:

Reliance Authorization

Eligibility asks:

Does the validation basis support this reliance?

Authorization asks:

May this actor actually rely upon it?

Authorization may depend upon other governance, organizational, contractual, legal, regulatory, safety, or risk structures.

VALIDOS® does not replace them.

Validation Does Not Create Deployment Permission

A system can be methodologically Validated and still not be authorized for deployment.

Deployment may require:

- risk acceptance,
- legal approval,
- safety approval,
- organizational authority,
- regulatory permission,
- infrastructure readiness,
- or other governance decisions.

Therefore:

Validated ≠ Authorized

and:

Reliance Eligible ≠ Deployment Approved

Reliance Conditions Must Survive

If validation is conditional, downstream reliance cannot discard those conditions.

For example:

Conditionally Validated with Human Oversight

cannot legitimately become:

Relied Upon Without Human Oversight

The condition must travel with the validation basis.

Reliance Restrictions Must Survive

Likewise:

Not Validated for Autonomous Execution

must remain visible wherever the Validation State is used as a reliance basis.

A validation restriction cannot disappear merely because the validation result has moved into another system or organization.

Reliance Limitations Must Remain Visible

Known validation limitations should remain available to the relying actor.

Examples may include:

- limited long-term evidence,
- limited edge-case coverage,
- limited population diversity,
- residual uncertainty,
- or limited independent testing.

The reliance decision should reflect the validation that actually exists, not an idealized version of it.

Reliance Can Be Human or Machine

The Relying Actor does not need to be human.

An AI system may rely upon:

- another AI model,
- validated data,
- a prediction,
- a simulation,
- a classifier,
- a sensor,
- an identity assertion,
- or another validated object.

An autonomous agent may therefore become a Relying Actor under VALIDOS®.

Machine Reliance Creates a New Operational Possibility

If Validation States become machine-readable, systems could theoretically ask before acting:

What is the current Validation State?

Does it apply to this use?

Is the object version correct?

Are required conditions satisfied?

Has validation expired?

Is revalidation required?

This creates the possibility of operational validation gates.

Validation as Operational Infrastructure

Traditional validation often ends in:

Report

or:

Certificate

VALIDOS® creates the possibility of:

Validation State → Machine-Readable Applicability → Reliance Gate → Operational Decision Validation can therefore become an active governance layer rather than passive documentation.

Reliance Chains

Modern systems rarely operate independently.

A typical chain may look like:

Dataset

↓

Foundation Model

↓

Specialized Model

↓

Decision Engine

↓

Autonomous Agent

↓

Operational Action

Each layer may rely upon validation information from another.

VRRS therefore recognizes:

Validation Reliance Chains

Validation Does Not Propagate Automatically

A validated component does not automatically validate the system containing it.

VALIDOS® establishes:

Validated Component ≠ Validated System

Validated Input ≠ Validated Output

Validated Model ≠ Validated Decision

Validated Decision Component ≠ Validated Autonomous Process

Every integration may introduce new validation questions.

Reliance Must Not Propagate Infinitely

Without governance, a validated artifact can gradually acquire authority it was never validated to possess.

For example:

Validated Dataset

becomes evidence for:

Validated Model which becomes assumed evidence for:

Validated Platform

which becomes assumed evidence for:

Validated Business Decision

VRRS prevents this uncontrolled propagation.

Reliance Dependency Mapping

Where many systems depend upon one validated object, VRRS
may identify:

Who relies upon it?

Where?

For what?

At what consequence?

This creates a **Reliance Dependency Map.**

Such mapping becomes especially important when validation changes.

When Validation Changes, Reliance Must Respond

Suppose a Validation Object transitions:

Validated → Validation Suspended

The validation lifecycle has changed.

But if downstream systems continue operating as if nothing happened,
the governance system has failed.

VRRS therefore connects:

Validation State Change

to:

Reliance Reassessment

Reliance Impact Propagation

A state change may propagate through a Reliance Chain.

For example:

Critical Dataset Validation Suspended

↓

Dependent Model Reliance Reassessment

↓

Decision Engine Reliance Reassessment ↓

Operational Process Review

VRRS creates the methodological basis for identifying these downstream consequences.

Reliance Can Be Restricted

A changed Validation State does not always require complete reliance termination.

For example:

Validated → Partially Validated

may result in:

Reliance continues only within the remaining validated scope.

This allows proportionate governance.

Reliance Can Be Suspended

Where current validation applicability becomes materially uncertain, reliance may be temporarily suspended.

Suspension says:

The current basis is insufficient to justify continued reliance until the uncertainty is resolved.

It does not automatically say:

The Validation Object is invalid.

Reliance Can Be Withdrawn

Where the validation basis no longer supports the intended Reliance Context, reliance may need to be withdrawn.

This may occur because:

- Validation State becomes Invalidated,
- scope is exceeded,
- the object materially changes,
- critical evidence fails,
- the relying purpose changes,

- or revalidation demonstrates insufficient support.

Reliance Itself Can Change

A Validation Object does not need to change for revalidation to become necessary.

The intended use can change.

For example:

AI used for internal research

becomes:

AI used for autonomous financial execution

The object may be identical.

The reliance consequence is not.

This creates a new validation question.

Reliance Escalation

VRRS recognizes:

Reliance Escalation

This occurs when the consequence, authority, autonomy, scale, or criticality of reliance materially increases.

A previously sufficient Validation Depth may become insufficient.

Reliance escalation can therefore trigger deeper validation.

Why Revalidation Is Part of the Same Standard

Reliance is only legitimate while its validation basis remains sufficient.

When that basis changes, VALIDOS® needs a mechanism for renewing it.

That mechanism is:

Revalidation

VRRS therefore joins two sides of one lifecycle:

Reliance upon existing validation

and:

renewal of validation when existing reliance can no longer be justified.

Revalidation Is Not Starting Again Automatically

One of the most important VRRS principles is:

Revalidation ≠ Automatic Complete Validation Restart

A system may have thousands of previously validated elements.

If one configuration changes, repeating every validation activity may be unnecessary.

The correct question is:

What changed, and which part of the validation basis does that change affect?

Validation Delta

VRRS therefore introduces the concept of:

Validation Delta

The Validation Delta compares:

Previously Validated Reality

with:

Current Reality and asks:

What changed?

What remained equivalent?

Which criteria are affected?

Which evidence remains usable?

Which sources remain reliable?

Which methods remain applicable?

Which validation activities must be repeated?

Validation Delta Enables Proportionate Revalidation

Without a Validation Delta, organizations face two bad options:

Do nothing

or:

Repeat everything

VRRS creates a third:

Revalidate what materially changed while preserving what remains legitimately validated.

Validation Reuse

Previous validation work may be reused where it remains:

- applicable,
- current,
- traceable,
- equivalent,
- sufficiently reliable,
- and methodologically compatible.

This can substantially reduce unnecessary validation effort.

Reuse Is Not Automatic

A historical validation artifact does not remain reusable merely because it exists.

VALIDOS® therefore establishes:

Previous Validation Exists ≠ Previous Validation Remains Applicable

Reuse itself must be governed.

Targeted Revalidation

A narrowly defined change may require:

Targeted Revalidation For example:

An AI system gains access to a new external tool.

The affected validation domains may concern:

- permission,
- execution,
- safety,
- tool interaction,

- and autonomy.

Unchanged unrelated domains may not require complete repetition.

Partial Revalidation

A broader but bounded change may require:

Partial Revalidation

For example:

one subsystem is replaced while other independently validated subsystems remain unchanged.

Full Revalidation

Full Revalidation becomes appropriate where:

- object equivalence is lost,
- architecture fundamentally changes,
- purpose fundamentally changes,
- scope broadly expands,
- prior validation is compromised,
- cumulative drift becomes extensive,
- or the new Reliance Context requires substantially different assurance.

Critical Revalidation

High-consequence changes may require stronger revalidation than the original validation.

For example:

A system previously validated for decision support may later receive autonomous authority over critical infrastructure.

The new validation requirement may require:

- deeper validation,
- stronger evidence,
- stronger source controls,
- independent validation,
- expanded execution,
- and stricter state conditions.

Revalidation Re-Enters VALIDOS®

Revalidation does not require a second validation architecture.

It re-enters the existing VALIDOS® lifecycle at the earliest materially affected layer.

For example: If only Source Reliability changes:

Source Reliability → Execution → Determination → State → Reliance

may require reassessment.

If the Validation Object fundamentally changes:

Validation Object

may become the correct re-entry point.

Selective Lifecycle Re-Entry

This creates an important architectural property.

VALIDOS® is not merely linear.

After the first validation cycle, it becomes:

Recursive

A later change can return the object to whichever validation layer has become materially affected.

VALIDOS® Becomes a Lifecycle Loop

The first validation cycle is:

Object → Purpose → Criteria → Method → Evidence → Sources → Execution → Determination → State → Reliance

Then reality changes.

The architecture becomes:

Reliance

↓

Change

↓

Revalidation Trigger

↓

Validation Delta

↓

Affected VALIDOS® Layer

↓

New Validation Activity

↓

New Determination

↓

New State ↓

Renewed Reliance

This closes the architecture.

Revalidation Must Produce a New Determination

Revalidation should ultimately establish a governed
Validation Determination.

Possible outcomes include:

Reaffirmed

Modified

Conditional

Partial

Negative

or:

Indeterminate

The goal of revalidation is not to renew the old
state automatically.

It is to determine current reality.

Revalidation Can Make Validation Worse

This is methodologically important.

A revalidation process may discover that the Validation Object is
less reliable than previously believed.

Therefore:

Revalidation ≠ Renewal

Revalidation is a new validation inquiry.

Revalidation Can Also Strengthen Validation

New evidence may allow:

Conditionally Validated → Validated

or:

Partially Validated → Validated

Revalidation can therefore strengthen, weaken, narrow, expand, or reaffirm the validation basis.

State Renewal Comes After Determination

The sequence remains governed:

Revalidation

↓ Validation Determination

↓

Validation State Assignment

↓

Reliance Reassessment

The old Validation State is not simply administratively renewed.

Reliance Renewal Comes Last

Even a successful new Validation State does not automatically restore every historical reliance.

The new state may:

- have different scope,
- carry different conditions,
- contain new restrictions,
- have different Validation Depth,
- or apply to a new version.

The Relying Actor must therefore reassess its own Reliance Context.

Revalidation Creates Validation Continuity

The complete chain becomes:

Previous Validation State

↓

Reliance

↓

Material Change

↓

Revalidation Required

↓

Validation Delta

↓

Revalidation

↓

New Validation Determination

↓

New Validation State

↓

Renewed Reliance

This is the complete VALIDOS® lifecycle.

Point-in-Time Reliance

VRRS also enables a powerful retrospective question:

Was reliance methodologically justified at the time the decision was made?

Answering it requires reconstructing:

- Validation State at that time,
- state applicability,

- Relying Actor,
- Reliance Purpose,
- Reliance Scope,
- conditions,
- restrictions,
- Validation Depth,
- revalidation status,
- and authorization where applicable.

This creates strong audit and accountability potential.

Validation Does Not Guarantee Outcomes

A legitimately validated system may still fail.

Validation cannot eliminate uncertainty.

Therefore:

Legitimate Reliance ≠ Guaranteed Correct Outcome

The governance question is:

Was reliance justified by the validation basis that existed at the time?

This distinction protects methodological integrity.

Validation Reliance Is Not Risk Acceptance

An organization may establish:

Reliance Eligible

while separately deciding that residual risk remains unacceptable.

Risk governance remains a separate decision domain.

VRRS therefore does not collapse validation into risk acceptance.

Validation Reliance Is Not Legal Compliance

Likewise:

Validated

does not mean:

Legally Compliant

unless legal compliance itself was the explicitly governed
Validation Object and purpose.

VALIDOS® should never silently substitute methodological validation for legal authority.

Validation Reliance Is Not Truth

A validated claim may possess strong methodological support.

That does not make VALIDOS® an absolute truth machine.

VALIDOS® governs:

- what was examined,
- against which criteria,
- by which method,
- using which evidence,
- from which sources,
- with what result,
- in which state,
- and for which reliance.

That distinction is central to the architecture.

Relationship to the Four-Layer Validation Protocol

The completed VALIDOS® architecture provides the methodological governance infrastructure from which the planned **four-layer validation protocol** can later be derived.

The protocol should not replace VALIDOS®.

VALIDOS® defines the complete validation governance architecture.

The protocol can operationalize selected architecture layers into a repeatable validation sequence.

This separation is important:

Architecture defines the governed space.

Protocol defines the operational sequence through that space.

The protocol can therefore become a compact operational implementation while VALIDOS® remains the reference architecture behind it.

Relationship to TVL

TVL can later occupy a specialized role without duplicating VALIDOS®.

VALIDOS® governs the architecture of validation.

The four-layer protocol can govern a repeatable validation process.

TVL can then be positioned according to its final canonical purpose within that ecosystem.

Keeping these layers separate prevents the intellectual structure from collapsing into one oversized concept.

Position Within VALIDOS®

Validation Reliance & Revalidation Standard is the tenth and final Parent Standard of **VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture.**

The complete Parent Standard sequence now governs:

1. What is being validated?

↓

2. Why and within what scope is it being validated?

↓

3. Against what must it be validated?

↓

4. How must validation be performed?

↓

5. Is the evidence fit for validation?

↓

6. Are the sources sufficiently reliable?

↓

7. Was validation executed correctly?

↓

8. What did validation determine?

↓

9. What Validation State does the object hold now?

↓

10. Who or what may rely upon that state, and when must validation be performed again?

The architecture now covers validation from object identification through operational reliance and back into revalidation.

From Linear Architecture to Recursive Architecture

This final Parent Standard changes the nature of VALIDOS®.

Standards 1–9 establish a governed validation path.

Standard 10 closes the path into a loop.

Therefore VALIDOS® becomes:

Object → Validation → State → Reliance → Change → Revalidation → State → Reliance

The architecture can theoretically continue throughout the entire life of the Validation Object.

Why This Matters for AI

AI systems increasingly:

- update continuously,
- depend upon changing data,
- use changing tools,
- interact with changing environments,
- acquire new capabilities,
- operate autonomously,
- depend upon other AI systems,
- and generate outputs consumed automatically by downstream systems.

A static validation certificate is poorly suited to that reality.

VALIDOS® instead creates a framework for:

Dynamic Validation Governance

where validation can possess:

- identity,
- scope,
- evidence,
- source lineage,
- determination,
- state,
- applicability,
- monitoring,
- transitions,
- reliance,
- and revalidation.

From Validation Document to Validation Infrastructure

The completed architecture creates a conceptual progression from:

Validation as Documentation

to:

Validation as Governed State

and ultimately:

Validation as Operational Infrastructure

A future implementation could theoretically allow systems to ask:

Is this object currently validated?

For what?

Against what?

At what depth?

Under which conditions?

May I rely upon it for this purpose?

Has anything changed?

Is revalidation required?

That is substantially different from merely storing a validation report.

Foundational Principle

Validation should be relied upon only within the scope, conditions, consequence, and time for which its current governed state can legitimately support that reliance—and when that basis changes, validation must change with it.

Canonical Closing Statement

Validation Reliance & Revalidation Standard completes VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture by establishing the governed boundary between possessing a Validation State and legitimately relying upon that state, while creating the recursive mechanism

through which changing objects, environments, evidence, sources, risks, purposes, scopes, and reliance contexts return validation to the appropriate methodological layer. By governing reliance purpose, scope, consequence, eligibility, conditions, restrictions, authorization, monitoring, dependency, suspension, withdrawal, Validation Delta, validation reuse, targeted, partial, full and critical revalidation, selective lifecycle re-entry, renewed determination, state renewal, and reliance continuity, VRRS transforms VALIDOS® from a linear validation framework into a continuous validation lifecycle in which validation remains bounded by the reality that justified it and capable of being renewed whenever that reality materially changes.

Parent Resources

→ VALIDOS® Architecture Map

→ VALIDOS® Complete Standards & Modules Index

Related Documents

→ Validation Reliance & Revalidation Standard

→ VALIDOS® Validation Governance Architecture — Validation Governance Layer

OOF® MIP® Protection Notice

OOF® · Protected under MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property

Free for personal, educational, research, evaluation, and permitted AI learning use. Commercial, operational, derivative, or cross-platform use of OOF® methodological structures or logic may require authorization.

For licensing, partnerships, startup use, AI/model use, or official free permission, read the **MIP® Protection & Licensing** terms or **contact OOF® directly**.

Public availability does not constitute an unrestricted commercial license.

Active Protection & Compatibility Detection applies.

Canonical Source

https://originopenfoundation.org/